

HONEYCOMB COCKTAIL LOUNGE • LIVERMORE

THE SIGNAL

*A city-wide alternate reality game that turns finding the door
into the best night out in the East Bay*

MARKETING CAMPAIGN PROPOSAL • 2026



THE INSIGHT

Exclusivity is already your brand.

People are exhausted, over-screened, and starved for real-world magic. **Escapism is the product** — and Honeycomb already sells it: no sign, a doorman, a weekly password.

This campaign doesn't change what you are.

It weaponizes it — your door becomes a citywide quest.

1 in 5

guests should feel like insiders — that scarcity is what the other four talk about

0 → 1

no Bay Area bar has run a full ARG — first-mover press writes itself

THE PRESS ALREADY PLAYS ALONG

Mercury News — Featured HCL among the Bay Area's hidden bars — the passphrase ritual is the hook.

Pleasanton Weekly — Led with the unmarked door: no sign, just hexagon panels and the initials HC.

Eater SF — Called Livermore's scene 'buzzing under the radar' with Honeycomb as its candidate for a great night out.

An ARG gives them a second story to write.

Three channels. One passphrase. One door.



THE BROADCAST

The 30-second transmission runs as paid social worldwide — targeting travelers hunting hidden Bay Area destinations. Inside: a numbers-station clue.

FRAGMENT 01



HIDDEN PRINT

Five prohibition-style posters downtown, each with a honeycomb QR hidden in the art. Together they spell fragment 2.

FRAGMENT 02



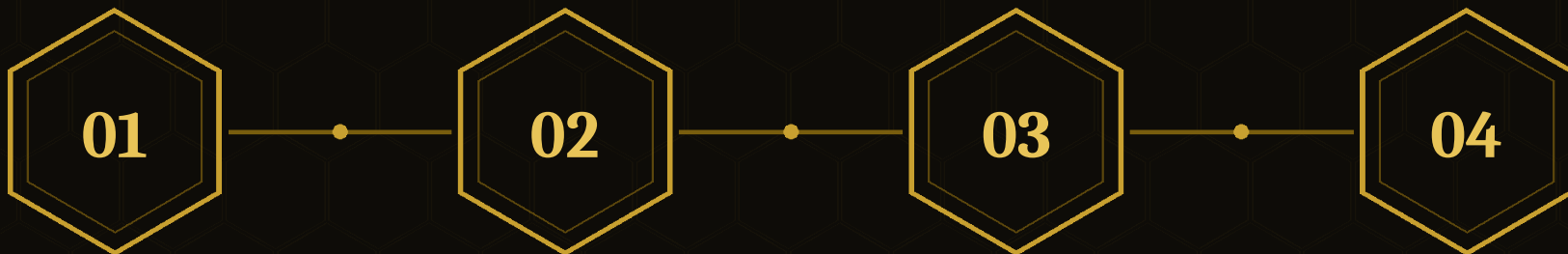
COMMUNITY TASKS

Weekly challenges on Instagram — photo hunts, decoded reels, the 15-second signal. Completing them earns fragment 3.

FRAGMENT 03

All three fragments → the passphrase → the door → **The Cipher cocktail + inner-circle credential**

Four phases, every season



HOOK

The signal appears: the broadcast drops in-feed worldwide, posters go up overnight

CHASE

Players decode numbers, hunt all five posters, complete weekly social tasks

CONVERGE

Fragments combine into the passphrase; community trades theories online

THE DOOR

Victors arrive, speak the phrase, and are inducted into the inner circle

THE ANTHOLOGY

Four seasons. Four games. Four ciphers.

SPRING

The Swarm

The hive wakes. A new signal cuts through the static — bright, floral, restless. The year's first hunt begins.

SUMMER

The Nectar Run

Golden hour, long nights. Clues ride the summer crowds downtown while the nectar flows.

FALL

The Harvest

Amber and smoke. The combs are heavy; the puzzles get darker and richer as the season turns.

WINTER

The Cluster

The hive goes quiet — but never still. The hardest game of the year, for the ones who stayed.

Every game: new passphrase · new Cipher variant · new credential colorway · new member-number series

Miss a season, miss that cipher forever — the collection is the retention loop.

A transmission the whole world can catch



THE SPOT — RUNS AS REELS, TIKTOK & YOUTUBE ADS

[beehive hum under slow acid-jazz • boom-bap enters]

“You remember when a night out felt like disappearing... There's still a place like that. You just have to find it.”

[static — a flat voice] **“Two. Three. Two. One.”**



Destination targeting

Travelers planning SF, wine-country & East Bay trips; “hidden bars” and speakeasy interest audiences worldwide



Signature sound

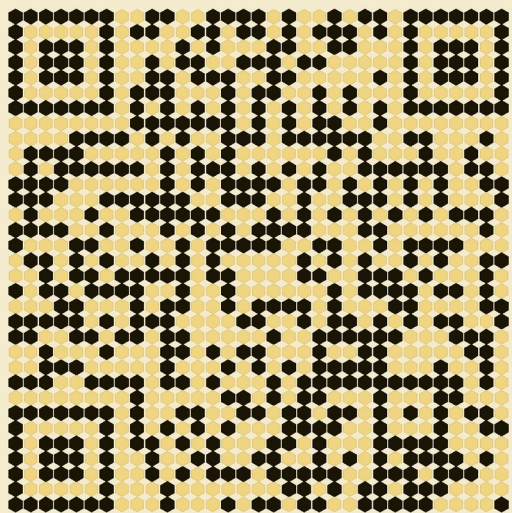
Live beehive under acid jazz + hip-hop — a scroll-stopper that's instantly ownable, instantly HCL



\$1.5–2.8K / game

Paid social CPMs reach thousands of qualified travelers per dollar — precision radio can't touch

Five posters. One QR made of honeycomb.



Fully scannable — every cell is a hex. Try it.

Prohibition-era design

Art deco line work, no logo, no address. Beautiful enough that people photograph it before they understand it.

The QR hides in plain sight

Rendered as honeycomb cells inside the illustration. Scanning lands on a dark, unbranded page: “You found the frequency.”

Five locations, five glyphs

Each poster carries one glyph. All five arrange into fragment 2 of the passphrase. Node-tagged URLs tell us which corners of downtown convert.

Print run + placement: ~\$800 for a 5-location downtown run, kraft stock, wheat-paste style

The 15-second signal



the_signal_001

*no caption · no tags
posted at midnight*



The mystery reel

Black screen. Beehive. Static. Three numbers. A door knock. Zero explanation — confusion is the share mechanic.



Weekly tasks

“Find the doorman under the umbrella. Don't speak. Just nod.” Completions get the next clue via auto-DM.



The comment hive

Players compare notes in public. The community solves it together — and that thread is free reach.



Already built-in

You post a weekly password today. The ARG upgrades that habit into a four-week story arc.

Two roads to the same door

THE FAST TRACK

Catches the broadcast in-feed

- Sees the ad, decodes the numbers, and starts hunting
- Travelers plan the trip around it — the game becomes the itinerary
- Typically finishes in the opening weeks — these are your superfans

THE LONG ROAD

Never sees the ad

- Stumbles on a poster downtown or the unexplained organic reel
- The QR page carries the broadcast audio — no one is locked out
- Slower, community-driven path; finishes late in the season

Same fragments, same finish line — the game meets people wherever they enter it.

THE PAYOFF

The door opens. The ceremony begins.

THE BARTENDER, WORD FOR WORD

"We've been expecting someone like you.

Not many people make it this far. You're not most people.

First drink's on the house. It's called The Cipher — we made it for whoever walked through that door first.

Tonight, that's you."



The Cipher

An exclusive cocktail that exists only for victors — never on the menu



The credential

A limited shirt that reads like a membership artifact, not merch



Member No. —

Hand-stamped sequential card. First run of 50. No expiry, no fine print.

"You found it. Most people never will."

INVESTMENT

Per-game core + one optional plugin

CORE CAMPAIGN • PER GAME • FOUR THEMED GAMES A YEAR

Paid social broadcast	Reels / TikTok / YouTube • global traveler targeting	\$1,500–2,800
Print production + placement	5 posters • kraft stock • downtown run	\$450
Landing pages + QR nodes	5 node URLs • dark microsite • auto-DM bot	\$250
Audio + video production	Beehive session • acid-jazz/boom-bap bed • VO • edit	\$500–700
Rewards	Limited shirt run • stamped cards • Cipher ingredients	\$600–900
Contingency + hints	Mid-game clue drops, replacement posters	\$200–400

CORE TOTAL / GAME	\$3,500–5,500
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PLUGIN • LATE-NIGHT RADIO

12 overnight spots — well under the current \$899/spot Bay Area blended average. Local mystique + a press angle no social buy can fake. Optional.

+\$4,000–6,000

Every step of the hunt is trackable



QR scans by node

Five tagged URLs show which streets convert — poster ROI in real numbers



Task completions

Auto-DM bot counts every finished social challenge, week by week



Doors opened

Passphrase redemptions at the door = hard conversion, not vanity reach



The after-curve

Reservations, follows, and press mentions in the 8 weeks post-game

Success looks like: 500K+ qualified impressions · 300+ node scans · 40+ victors at the door · 2+ earned press pieces

Most bars buy attention.

Honeycomb makes people earn it.

Four seasons. Three channels. One door.
Let's start the transmission.

THE SIGNAL · HONEYCOMB COCKTAIL LOUNGE · 2321 FIRST STREET, LIVERMORE

